THE BIG STORY
BJP

THE NEW BATTLE FRONTS

Buoyed by the landslide victory in Bihar, the BJP enters 2026 with its sights set on the last frontiers, West Bengal and the southern outliers

By ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

THE CELEBRATIONS WERE UNDER WAY at the BJP headquarters in New Delhi on November 14 after the landslide victory in the Bihar election and, as is the convention by now, Prime Minister Narendra Modi was there to address party workers. After the customary messages of congratulation, the PM employed his usual oratorial flourish to declare: "The Ganga flows from Bihar to Bengal." The message was clear: carry the momentum eastward and prepare for what BJP insiders are calling "the mother of all assembly polls".

West Bengal, along with Assam, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry, is scheduled to go for assembly polls in April-May next year. At the BJP headquarters, the mood is upbeat. The confidence comes, as a top party leader explains, because the back-to-back victories in the states have reaffirmed that the Modi-Amit Shah model—tight control, focused messaging and relentless preparation—combined with the leave-no-stone-unturned groundwork of the Sangh Parivar, is near-unstoppable.

As a prelude to election preparations, the restructuring of state units is likely to be completed by year-end. Sources say new chiefs for the Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, Haryana and Delhi units will be announced soon, while Punjab and Jharkhand—currently under working presidents—will get full-time leaders as well. The objective is to harvest



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